



Adam Dennett

PROFESSOR OF URBAN ANALYTICS

Bartlett Centre for Advanced Spatial Analysis, University College London

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Profile

I am Professor of Urban Analytics at the Bartlett Centre for Advanced Spatial Analysis (CASA), University College London. My research uses data and quantitative methods — frequently in R — to understand cities, migration, housing and the systems people create. I publish across migration modelling (particularly spatial interaction models), housing and energy, gentrification, synthetic data and the geographies of beer and brewing, and have a passion for applied work in urban policy contexts.

Professional History

Professor of Urban Analytics

BARTLETT CENTRE FOR ADVANCED SPATIAL ANALYSIS, UCL

2021–Present

Head of Department and Director

BARTLETT CENTRE FOR ADVANCED SPATIAL ANALYSIS, UCL

2018–2023

Associate Professor, Urban Analytics

BARTLETT CENTRE FOR ADVANCED SPATIAL ANALYSIS, UCL

2017–2021

Deputy Director

BARTLETT CENTRE FOR ADVANCED SPATIAL ANALYSIS, UCL

2016–2018

Lecturer in Urban Analytics

BARTLETT CENTRE FOR ADVANCED SPATIAL ANALYSIS, UCL

2013–2017

Post-doctoral Research Associate

BARTLETT CENTRE FOR ADVANCED SPATIAL ANALYSIS, UCL

2010–2013

Research Assistant and part-time PhD student

SCHOOL OF GEOGRAPHY, UNIVERSITY OF LEEDS

2006–2010

Teacher of Geography and Head of General Studies

HEDINGHAM SCHOOL, ESSEX

2002–2005

Education

PhD in Quantitative Human Geography

SCHOOL OF GEOGRAPHY, UNIVERSITY OF LEEDS

2007–2011

- Studied part-time

MA in Human Geography with Geographic Information Systems

SCHOOL OF GEOGRAPHY, UNIVERSITY OF LEEDS

2005–2006

- Pass with Distinction

Qualified Teacher Status (QTS)

NATIONAL COLLEGE OF TEACHING AND LEADERSHIP, DfE

2003–2003

PGCE in Secondary Geography

FACULTY OF EDUCATION (HOMERTON COLLEGE), UNIVERSITY OF CAMBRIDGE

2001–2002

BSc (Hons) Geography

LANCASTER UNIVERSITY

1998–2001

Appointments and Affiliations

Member, ESRC Peer Review College ESRC	2024–Present
External Examiner, MSc Geographical Information Science UNIVERSITY OF MANCHESTER	2023–Present
Editor-in-Chief, Applied Spatial Analysis and Policy (Impact Factor 1.9) SPRINGER	2017–2023
Fellow of the Academy of Social Sciences (FACSS) — Elected ACADEMY OF SOCIAL SCIENCES	2021–Present
Fellow of the Royal Geographical Society (FRGS) ROYAL GEOGRAPHICAL SOCIETY	2010–Present

Prizes, Awards and Honours

Best Paper, 33rd Annual GIS Research UK (GISRUK) Conference UNIVERSITY OF BRISTOL	2025
Elected Fellow of the Academy of Social Sciences (FACSS) ACADEMY OF SOCIAL SCIENCES	2021
Cabinet Office Geospatial Commission, Geography in Government Award — Excellence in Local Government AWARDED WITH CITY OF WESTMINSTER COUNCIL FOR PIONEERING URBAN LAB WORK	2020
Best Paper, 27th Annual GIS Research UK (GISRUK) Conference (Colouring London Project) UNIVERSITY OF NEWCASTLE	2019
UCLU Student Choice Teaching Award for Outstanding Teaching UNIVERSITY COLLEGE LONDON	2016
Grebenik Prize — best work on any aspect of human population problems UNIVERSITY OF LEEDS	2006

Grants

External grants total awarded as PI or Co-I since 2012: **£17,491,621.90**.

Census Innovation at CeLSIUS (ES/Z502741/1) Co-I; ACTIVE • £384,576	2024
TRACK-UK: Synthesized Census and Small Area Statistics for Transport and Energy (ES/Z50290X/1) Co-I; ACTIVE • £327,680	2024
AI for Collective Intelligence (AI4CI) — UKRI AI Research Hub for Real Data (EP/Y028392/1) Co-I; LOCAL PI FOR UCL BRANCH; ACTIVE • £10,274,279 (UCL portion £980,391.77)	2024
Pathways to socially equitable net-zero cities and regions — ESRC CASE PhD Studentship PI/SUPERVISOR (TRANSPORT EAST PARTNER); ACTIVE • £93,633.90	2023
Equity Assessment of Demand-side Flexibility Technologies in Grid Integrated Transport Electrification (PhD) PI/SUPERVISOR (EPSRC CREDS); ACTIVE • £96,044	2023

NARRATE

PI; COMPLETE

2022

- £142,739.24 (Ordnance Survey)

dunnhumby PhD Studentship

PI/SUPERVISOR (INDUSTRY-FUNDED); COMPLETE

2020

- £60,000 (dunnhumby)

CeLSIUS (ES/V003488/1)

Co-I; ACTIVE

2020

- £2,160,348.40 (ESRC)

YOUR.VU.CITY (UKRI 105325)

LOCAL PI (Co-I ON WHOLE PROJECT); COMPLETE

2019

- £620,697 (UCL £159,996; Innovate UK)

CeLSIUS Re-commissioning (ES/R00823X/1)

Co-I; COMPLETE

2018

- £1,020,753 (ESRC)

Colouring London Impact Acceleration Grant

PI; COMPLETE

2018

- £55,200 (EPSRC)

CeLSIUS Extension Grant

Co-I; COMPLETE

2016

- £247,182.40 (ESRC)

Colouring London

PI (WITH Co-PI POLLY HUDSON); COMPLETE

2016

- £58,400.74 (Historic England)

RGS Innovative Teaching Grant

PI (Co-I PAUL TURNER, BEDALES SCHOOL); COMPLETE

2014

- £1,000 (RGS)

SYLLS — Synthetic data estimation for the UK Longitudinal Studies

PI; COMPLETE

2013

- £272,652.73 (ESRC)

CeLSIUS (ES/K000365/1)

Co-I; COMPLETE

2012

- £1,676,436 (ESRC)

Invited Talks (recent)

UCL Development Planning Unit — talk to Latin American city leaders

SMART CITIES AND COLLECTIVE INTELLIGENCE

Sept 2025

Royal Geographical Society Annual Conference

GIS VS THE CITY COUNCIL: DATA ANALYTICS, COLLECTIVE INTELLIGENCE AND POLICY DUST-UPS (GISRUK 2025 BEST PAPER)

Aug 2025

Brighton Data Forum (public lecture)

THE CASE OF THE BRIGHTON SECONDARY SCHOOL ADMISSIONS CONSULTATION

March 2025

Institute for Spatial Data Science, University of Leeds (departmental seminar)

DATA ANALYTICS AND THE BRIGHTON SECONDARY SCHOOL ADMISSIONS DEBATE

Feb 2025

Parent Support Group, Brighton (online public lecture)

DATA AND EVIDENCE MISSING FROM THE B&H SECONDARY SCHOOL ADMISSIONS CONSULTATION

Jan 2025

Alan Turing Institute / University of Glasgow

EARLY CAREER RESEARCHER PANEL, URBAN ANALYTICS MEETING

Dec 2024

Aalto University, Finland	
HOUSING AND NET-ZERO	Sept 2024
Geographic Data Science Lab, University of Liverpool (departmental seminar)	
EVIDENCE AGAINST THE EFFECTS OF SCHOOLS ON LOCAL HOUSE PRICES IN BRIGHTON AND HOVE	Feb 2024
Carto Spatial Data Science Bootcamp, London (invited back)	
FOUNDATIONS OF GEOSPATIAL	Nov 2023
Carto annual conference, Royal Geographical Society, London	
CAREERS PANEL	May 2023
Carto Spatial Data Science Bootcamp, London	
FOUNDATIONS OF GEOSPATIAL	Feb 2023

PhD Supervision

CURRENT RESEARCH STUDENTS

1st supervisor	
MARIA WOOD — EQUITY ASSESSMENT OF DEMAND-SIDE FLEXIBILITY TECHNOLOGIES IN TRANSPORTATION DECARBONISATION (WITH ESRA SUEL, GERRY CASEY). UPGRADE PASSED.	2023
1st supervisor	
CLAUDE LYNCH — PATHWAYS TO SOCIALLY EQUITABLE NET ZERO CITIES AND REGIONS (WITH ESRA SUEL, GERRY CASEY). UPGRADE PASSED.	2023
1st supervisor	
TOM MURAT — GENERATIVE SCENARIOS FOR GETTING TRANSPORT TO AN EQUITABLE NET ZERO (WITH ESRA SUEL, GERRY CASEY).	2023
1st supervisor	
DENISE MIZZI (PT) — SMALL AREA ESTIMATION OF WHEEZING PREVALENCE IN MALTESE SCHOOL CHILDREN (WITH JENS KANDT, NICOLA SHELTON). UPGRADE PASSED.	2018
2nd supervisor	
ROEI YOSIFOF — APPLICATION OF NOVEL AI METHODS IN THE DIGITAL URBAN PLANNING DOMAIN. AI4CI LINKED PHD.	2025
2nd supervisor	
AI4CI LINKED PHD (GLASGOW HALF OF CITIES THEME) — CANDIDATE APPOINTED.	2025
2nd supervisor	
CHIARA GERICKE — ROLE OF THE NEIGHBOURHOOD FOOD ENVIRONMENT IN SUSCEPTIBILITY TO OBESITY (1ST SUP. CLAIRE LLEWELLYN, INSTITUTE OF EPIDEMIOLOGY AND HEALTH CARE).	2023
COMPLETED	
1st supervisor	
PHILIP WILKINSON — APPLICATIONS OF NOVEL RETAIL MODELLING METHODOLOGIES IN AN EVOLVING GROCERY SECTOR (2ND SUP. NEAVE O’CLERY). MINOR CORRECTIONS.	2020 – 2023
1st supervisor	
BONNIE BUYUKLIEVA — UNDERSTANDING LONDON’S RESIDENTIAL METABOLISM (2ND SUP. HANNAH FRY). MINOR CORRECTIONS.	2016 – 2022
1st supervisor	
BIN CHI — SPATIAL AND TEMPORAL PATTERNS OF RESIDENTIAL HOUSE PRICES AND AFFORDABILITY IN THE UK (2ND SUP. THOMAS OLÉRON EVANS). PASSED WITHOUT CORRECTIONS.	2016 – 2021
1st supervisor	
MATTHEW NG — THE FUTURE OF BRUNEI: CHANGES IN BRUNEI-MUARA’S URBAN AND POPULATION LANDSCAPES (2ND SUP. ELSA ARCAUTE). MINOR CORRECTIONS.	2016 – 2020
2nd supervisor	
YUFENG WU — DYNAMICS OF RETURN MIGRATION INTENTION AND BEHAVIOUR IN CHINA (1ST SUP. RORY COULTER).	2019 – 2024

2nd supervisor

LIXUN LIU — IMPACTS OF RAIL TRANSIT INVESTMENT ON DEVELOPMENT IN CHONGQING (1ST SUP. ROBIN HICKMAN). MINOR CORRECTIONS.

2015 – 2016

MSc / MRes

Supervised 45+ dissertations between 2017–2025. Joshua Yee (2019) won the RGS-IBG Population Geography Research Group postgraduate dissertation prize.

Research Staff Line Management

Dr Beatrice Taylor; Adham Enaya; Dr Yahya Gamal (Glasgow — oversight) AI FOR COLLECTIVE INTELLIGENCE NATIONAL RESEARCH HUB	2024-Present
Dr Bonnie Buyuklieva (now Lecturer in Digital Humanities, UCL) NARRATE — ORDNANCE SURVEY HOUSING NET ZERO R&D PROJECT	2022-2023
Dr Martin de Jode (now Lecturer in CASA); Maciej Ziarkowski; Dominic Humphrey (now UCL Energy Institute) COLOURING LONDON (CASA)	2018-2020
Dr Belinda Wu SYLLS	2013-2014

Academic Staff Line Management

Currently line-manage 2 academic staff. As Head of Department over a 5-year period directly line-managed (seeing several through promotions):

- 3 Professors (one successfully re-banded during period)
- 6 Associate Professors (2 promoted to Professor during period)
- 4 Lecturers (2 promoted to Associate Professor during period)

Selected Publications (since 2020)

A full list is available via Google Scholar and ORCID 0000-0001-8036-0185.

Lynch, C.E.H., Casey, G., Suel, E., Dennett, A. IS TRANSPORT MODELLING 'A BIT OF A RACKET'? ON THE ROLE OF TRANSPORT PLANNING SUPPORT SYSTEMS IN ENGLAND. *TRANSPORTATION RESEARCH INTERDISCIPLINARY PERSPECTIVES* 36. DOI:10.1016/J.TRIP.2026.101876	2026
Wood, M., Dennett, A., Casey, G., Suel, E. CAR DEPENDENCE IN ENGLAND AND WALES: SPATIAL INEQUALITIES AND IMPLICATIONS FOR A JUST TRANSITION. *FRONTIERS IN SUSTAINABLE CITIES* 7. DOI:10.3389/FRSC.2025.1719495	2026
Horsfall, L., Kennedy, C., Shelton, N., Taylor, J., Hurst, J.R., Loxham, M., Dennett, A., Hardelid, P. HIGH-RESOLUTION MAPPING OF RESIDENTIAL WOOD BURNING HEAT SOURCES USING ENERGY PERFORMANCE CERTIFICATES. *ENVIRONMENT INTERNATIONAL* 201. DOI:10.1016/J.ENVINT.2025.109537	2025
Tan, J., Dennett, A. DO GOOD SCHOOLS INFLUENCE PROPERTY PRICES? DISENTANGLING SCHOOL AND NEIGHBOURHOOD EFFECTS WITH EMPIRICAL EVIDENCE FROM BRIGHTON. IN *DIGITAL-ERA URBAN TRANSFORMATIONS* (CUPUM). DOI:10.1007/978-3-031-98300-9_17	2025
Dennett, A., Bullock, S., Ajmeri, N., Batty, M., Black, M., Cartlidge, J., ..., Williams, H.T.P. ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE FOR COLLECTIVE INTELLIGENCE: A NATIONAL-SCALE RESEARCH STRATEGY. *KNOWLEDGE ENGINEERING REVIEW* DOI:10.1017/S0269888924000110	2024
Buyuklieva, B., Bevilacqua, I., Dennett, A., Reades, J., Hubbard, P. LIFE FOR RENT: EVOLVING RESIDENTIAL INFRASTRUCTURE IN LONDON AND THE RISE OF BUILT-TO-RENT. *URBAN STUDIES* DOI:10.1177/00420980241277684	2024

Chi, B., Dennett, A., Evans, T., Morphet, R.

SHEDDING NEW LIGHT ON RESIDENTIAL PROPERTY PRICE VARIATION IN ENGLAND: A MULTI-SCALE EXPLORATION.

2020

ENVIRONMENT AND PLANNING B. DOI:10.1177/2399808320951212